

Grant Proposal - Internal Research Fund (Kabarak University)

Project Title and Summary

Title: Catalyzing Homegrown Research: Advancing Strategic Innovation Through Internal Grants at Kabarak University

This project proposes a university-wide capacity-building initiative aimed at strengthening the research culture at Kabarak University by utilizing the Internal Research Fund. The initiative will fund interdisciplinary projects led by faculty and postgraduate students that align with Kenya Vision 2030, the African Union Agenda 2063, and the UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). Through targeted support in research development, mentorship, and dissemination, the university seeks to produce socially relevant, locally grounded, and internationally recognized research outputs.

The project emphasizes areas including health, education, environmental sustainability, ICT, law, and theology. Each funded team will be guided through a research lifecycle-proposal development, ethics approval, data collection, analysis, and publication. The program will culminate in an annual university research symposium and a peer-reviewed internal journal to disseminate findings.

Citations:

- Kabarak University Directorate of Research, Innovation and Outreach (2024)
- Government of Kenya. (2007). Vision 2030.
- United Nations. (2015). Transforming our world: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

Problem Statement and Need for the Project

Despite the growing number of faculty and postgraduate students at Kabarak University, research output remains limited due to insufficient funding, mentorship, and publishing platforms. Many promising ideas stall at the proposal stage due to a lack of financial and technical support. Furthermore, faculty members often lack opportunities to collaborate across disciplines or access high-impact publishing opportunities.

The internal research grant seeks to bridge this gap by offering seed funding and a structured research support mechanism. This approach empowers researchers to explore local challenges-such as maternal health outcomes, climate adaptation, and ICT integration in education-through evidence-based inquiry. The need is especially critical as Kabarak University aspires to achieve Tier-1 research status and contribute to national development priorities.

Additionally, as Kenya shifts its university funding model toward performance-based metrics, research output becomes a key indicator of institutional sustainability and academic competitiveness.

Citations:

- Kabarak University Strategic Plan 2021-2026.
- Kenya Commission for University Education (CUE). (2022). Quality Indicators for University Research.
- National Research Fund Kenya. (2023). State of Research Funding in Kenya.

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Project Goals and Objectives

Goal:

To strengthen Kabarak University's research capacity by providing strategic seed funding and support to faculty-led and postgraduate research initiatives through the Internal Research Fund.

Objectives:

1. To award at least 10 competitive internal research grants annually to interdisciplinary research teams.
2. To increase the number of peer-reviewed publications produced by faculty and students by 30% within 2 years.
3. To host an annual university research symposium showcasing funded project outcomes.
4. To develop and maintain an online institutional repository and internal academic journal to disseminate local research.
5. To provide targeted mentorship and capacity-building workshops on proposal writing, research ethics, and scientific publishing.

These objectives are aligned with national and global development goals and emphasize sustainable research practices that address local needs.

Citations:

- UNESCO. (2022). Building Research Capacity in African Universities.
- Kabarak University Research Policy Document (2021).
- African Union. (2015). Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want.

Methodology and Work Plan

The methodology follows a phased approach:

Phase 1: Call and Proposal Evaluation (Months 1-2)

- Launch an internal call for proposals with clear criteria aligned with Vision 2030 and SDG priorities.
- A multidisciplinary review committee will score proposals based on relevance, feasibility, and innovation.

Phase 2: Capacity Building (Months 2-4)

- Conduct workshops on research ethics, methodology, and scientific writing.
- Assign each grantee a mentor from a pool of senior faculty or research fellows.

Phase 3: Project Execution (Months 5-10)

- Funded researchers will begin implementation with periodic check-ins and technical support.
- All projects must obtain ethical clearance where applicable.

Phase 4: Dissemination (Months 11-12)

- Research outputs will be presented at the Kabarak Annual Research Symposium.

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- Selected studies will be published in the newly established Kabarak Journal of Applied Research.

Citations:

- Elsevier. (2023). Research Lifecycle Framework.
- Kabarak ICT Services Department. (2024). Online Research Support Systems.
- COHRED. (2019). Ethics and Capacity Development in Health Research.

Budget and Resource Allocation

The total proposed budget for the initial implementation year is KES 5,000,000. The breakdown is as follows:

Category	Estimated Cost (KES)
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Research Grants (10 x KES 300,000)	3,000,000
Capacity Building Workshops (3 events)	500,000
Symposium Organization	400,000
Journal Development and OJS Setup	500,000
Monitoring & Evaluation	300,000
Administrative Costs	300,000

Funding will be managed by the Directorate of Research and audited according to university financial policies. Recipients must submit a detailed work plan and budget as part of their proposal and submit quarterly progress reports.

Citations:

- Kabarak University Financial Regulations Manual (2021).
- National Research Fund Kenya (2023). Institutional Grant Management Best Practices.
- Association of Commonwealth Universities. (2020). Managing University Research Funds.